HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 4

VIGILLINE DAILY

THURSDAY, 29 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Pfizer's Indian cancer-drug plant will stay shut for up to two years

The factory is already contributing to cancer drug shortages, Endpoints News reports. The account names neither the site nor the products it made, and puts no figure on the shortfall.

Pfizer has been forced to temporarily close a cancer drug factory in India, a site that will not reopen for up to two years and is already contributing to cancer drug shortages, Endpoints News reported. The report places the closure against heavy monsoon rain in July, without stating what the rain damaged.

The number that matters for anyone mapping oncology supply is the two years, not the shutdown itself. A plant idle for a season is a disruption to be managed from inventory; a plant idle for two years is a capacity decision, in which the output is either requalified at another site or the products are carried through allocation while a rebuild proceeds. The first route runs through manufacturing filings in every market the plant supplied, and the report does not list those markets.

What the material reviewed also leaves out is the identity of the factory, the cancer medicines it produced, the volume it represented, whether any of those products were single-sourced, and Pfizer's own account of the remediation. The contribution to shortages is reported as a characterisation rather than a quantity, so this issue makes no estimate of doses or revenue at risk.

For competitive intelligence the useful follow-up is a product-level one: which oncology lines were made at the site, who else holds approval for them, and whether the shortage is being absorbed by substitution or by allocation. None of that is answerable from the summary reviewed, and none of it should be assumed from the size of the company involved.

IN NUMBERS

Up to two years

period for which Pfizer's closed cancer-drug factory in India will remain shut, per Endpoints News

$285 million

value of Astellas's exclusive option on a preclinical IL-12 asset from Audax Biosciences, covering an upfront fee and one contingent payment

$600 million

size of the fund Formation Bio has raised to acquire, develop and hand off assets

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CPHI India & PMEC India 2026 to connect India's pharma value chain across ingredients, manufacturing and technology
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Ayushman Bharat data 'a gamechanger' for India and the Global South: Dr M Srinivas
ET HEALTHWORLD

BRIEFS

Analysts press Biogen on litifilimab before pivotal lupus readouts

Scrutiny of Biogen's late-stage pipeline is intensifying ahead of several Phase 3 readouts that Endpoints News describes as pivotal to chief executive Chris Viehbacher's turnaround. Analysts put numerous questions to Viehbacher and other executives about the trials. The summary reviewed gives no readout dates, endpoints or effect sizes.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

HHS stops enforcing the ban on compounding some wellness peptides

HHS said on Wednesday it will stop enforcing a ban on the compounding of certain popular peptides used for wellness purposes while the FDA works on rulemaking to address the substances, Endpoints News reported. STAT noted that Kennedy and his MAHA movement have embraced peptides although evidence for many wellness compounds is limited.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Astellas takes an option on a preclinical IL-12 cancer drug from Audax

Astellas has taken an exclusive option to license a preclinical IL-12 immuno-oncology asset from the Australian biotech Audax Biosciences for $285 million, a sum that covers the upfront fee and a payment due if a stated condition is met, Endpoints News reported. The summary does not name the asset or the remaining milestones.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Formation Bio raises a $600 million fund for its acquire-and-hand-off model

Formation Bio, an AI-focused biotech that acquires outside assets, develops them and then hands them off, has raised a $600 million investment fund to double down on that strategy, Endpoints News reported. The summary does not give the fund's investors, its term or how many assets it will hold.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

78% of scientists now expect AI to speed drug discovery this year

Endpoints Signal, which a year ago surveyed almost 1,500 biopharma insiders and found scientists the most sceptical about AI in drug discovery, reports that 78% of scientists now say it will speed the work this year. The summary reviewed gives neither the current sample size nor the question's wording.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Heatwave exposure for older adults and infants fell from its 2024 record

Heatwave exposure for older adults and infants combined made 2025 the second highest year on record: older adults were exposed to 10.8 billion person-days and infants to 1.1 billion, against 2024's high of 15.3 billion and 2.3 billion respectively, ET HealthWorld reported. India is among the countries with the highest exposure for both groups.

ET HEALTHWORLD

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